

Q.8a (20 marks): Everything has turned out to be at least somewhat heritable yet nothing has turned out to be ab...



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- Q.8) (a) Everything has turned out to be at least somewhat heritable (passed down), yet nothing has turned out to be absolutely heritable. Explain the statement in context of nature-nurture debate in Anthropology. (20 marks)

Eric Turkheimer gave the above quotation that everything of one's trait or character is due to effect of both nature & nurture.

The statement considers the fact that both nature & nurture are working together and it never ^{the only} just one in confrontation with other.

Nature - Nurture Debate

It is one of the central debate in Anthropology & other disciplines. The debate arises in order to find the whether nature is more important in human development or it is nurture. (~~environment~~)

It is in other words the debate between the 'genetics' of an individual & the 'environment' in which he/she grows.

Various thinkers & their viewpoints

1) Nature extremists like F. Galton, Darwin, Nuxley, etc took the side of nature saying that it's only genetics that's important in determining ~~the~~ one's personality.

2) Blacks can never achieve the mental or cognitive ability like European counterparts - was accepted notion by them

2) Nurture extremists - various anthropological thinkers like F. Boas, Mead, Benedict, etc opposed Nature determinism & explored how nurture plays important role in determining character of individuals.

40! Mead's study of sex & temperance in
3 societies

3/ Current status of debate

The newer studies have discovered
the relevance of arguments of both side.

While it is seen that genetics
determines the direction one might take
as an individual but its nurture or
environment which shall determine the
extent of one's development, as without
adequate support or care, no talent is
manifested.

Case Studies

1) Eric Turkheimer study of IQ inheritance

It ~~found~~ ^{studied} ~~that~~ twins who were
reared apart and belonging to different
class of society. It found that ~~twins~~ IQ
of twins in well nourished family dependent

on ~~environment~~ ^{genetic} while IQ of twins in impoverished families dependent on environment because inadequate support suppressed their IQ.

2) Alcoholism : It's found that although genetic predisposition exist for alcoholism, an individual won't turn alcoholic if not triggered by internal factors, like stress, trauma, etc.

3) ~~Common~~ New age diseases - Various diseases like diabetes, hypertension, cardiac attack, etc are now considered multifactorial in that both genetic & environment are causative agents.

Therefore, the debate is outdated & it's now a wisdom that both genetic & environment are important for human development.